

Don't Underestimate Your Enemy

It has come to my knowledge over the last ten years, from testimonies that come from time to time, that witches and people knowledgeable in Satan's operation, who purposely serve him, have been gathering together. Not only have human sacrifice and these kinds of things increased, but the devil has evidently found faithful disciples who will fast and chant to the lord of darkness, the prince of darkness, Satan himself.

As he directs their chantings and prayers, they have isolated and moved in on the destruction of the Christian family unit, the morality of Christians, and specifically the wives and husbands of ministers.

In the last ten years we have seen a tremendous increase in immorality in the Christian family and in divorce. What inspired me to preach on divorce that one time was God, of course, but what afflicted my spirit was watching a television program. I noticed three international ministries on it, including the host, and all of them had gone into second marriages since answering their international call. They all had an international ministry with their previous wives, and now they had an international ministry with the one they had. Somewhere along the line, their marriages disintegrated and broke up.

Wanting to understand how this works, I began to pray. Over the last five years, especially when I have ministered in preachers' conferences, I have seen it again and again. In Tucson, with eighty preachers present, we ministered on Satan's war machine, the counterfeit operation of Satan's body as opposed to the body of Christ.

It would shock you how many preachers want counseling. They do not want to talk in front of anybody. They want to go off to the side. After I heard one story, I probably heard a hundred. These are not things they would just walk up and tell a preacher. But because we preached and unfolded how Satan works in these areas, these preachers felt confident enough to open up.

They would say, "The things you are preaching on are exactly what I have been caught up in these last few years. I do not like it. I hate it. I hate the lasciviousness of the flesh. It is not that I do not have a beautiful wife. I have beautiful kids. In many cases I have a successful church. It is just that something is working, and I do not know how to stop it. I do not know how to come out of it."

I knew witches and others were fasting for the destruction and immorality of Christians. What I did not understand was how they could join themselves to Satan against the church and you and I would feel the effect of it.

These people who fast and chant to Satan, or fast and pray to Satan, should not be mistaken for people he cares about. He hates those deceived, rebellious human beings as much as he hates Christians. Believers are in the image of God, and he hates them. But as long as those who serve him will serve his purpose, he will burn them up and discard them.

I wondered, "God, how does a group of people fasting and chanting to Satan affect us?"

Satan finally gets a mouthpiece. He gets people who indoctrinate other people. He gets people who gather together in government and change laws. He uses the movie industry, the entertainment industry, media, newspapers, and magazines. The devil knows that if he can get human beings to serve him, he can begin to indoctrinate the masses. That is exactly how he works, until human beings are imprisoned in a prison they can hardly break out of.

The few people he gets to serve him give him power in the indoctrination of the masses.

Satan is smart enough to know how much God loves human beings. I used to question the employment of His love when I watched people die in agony, screaming and in pain. I never questioned His love, only the employment of it.

But since He has indoctrinated me into the peace of God, there are no more questions in my heart. In fact, I continue to be amazed at the depth of His grace, mercy, and love. I am swamped by it. When I look back over my own life, the way He has dealt with me is incredible. Nobody could love this faulted human being the way my Father does. My Father, my wife, and my family love me better than anybody.

So why should Satan, knowing how much God loves human beings, reinvent the wheel? Why should he study humanity for six thousand years to come up with a better plan for its seduction? Would it not be more beneficial to him to study the method God uses to indoctrinate and transform us into the fullness of God, then counterfeit that operation in reverse to destroy human beings?

God goes after us first through the Word, then transformation, yieldedness, and purging, until we draw close to Him. Satan goes after human beings first with indoctrination, then transformation in reverse, then defeat and destruction.

Why reinvent the wheel? Counterfeit what works.

The devil knows God loves you so much that He spared nothing for your redemption and recovery. So Satan counterfeits it. That is what we are going to look at this morning.

Right here in this room, some of you are not merely on the edge. You are living a double standard. There is no use anybody else hating you for the lasciviousness of the flesh you are living in. You hate yourself enough already for being out of control.

Do you know what entrapment is? It is when you do not want to hurt the people closest to you.

When God began the process of purging me from exaggerating and lying, it hurt. I had to tell my wife some things that cut me so deep, but it was necessary for my purging.

Some of you love the close ones around you. You love your friends. You love your wife. God forbid they would ever believe that privately you are caught up in anything to this extent in the flesh. Because the close loved ones cannot know, you enter an entrapment situation where you must go

to church, perform your duties, raise your hands, and go through all the motions.

The amazing thing is the way God will still bless through those things. Do not shake your head too hard; you will give yourself away.

Even though this may be a quiet part of the message, there are many people caught up in this. I have been counseling it. Just last week I had two or three counseling appointments with preachers who came in wanting to pour it all out.

I am not talking about the ordinary cares of this life, normal fear, and those kinds of things. I am talking about lasciviousness of the flesh, promiscuousness, and filthiness of the flesh. James calls it "superfluity of naughtiness." King James had some silver-tongued language there.

Of course, we do not want to know whether you are caught up in this kind of thing. I know you have probably been in prayer lines for it. How many times have you made up your mind to quit? After you fell to it, after the gratification was over and guilt set back in, your spirit chastised you. Maybe you hid the pornographic magazine, or even burned it, only to go get another one.

Are we talking roughly? Yes. We want to salvage some souls from hell, and we are going to get into this kind of prayer.

You may not be listening too well right now. But when we get to the part about what to do to get yourself out of it, you might start listening. Try to appear a little nonchalant about it. Do not look down too long, or everyone around you will know you are having a good time.

Why should Satan reinvent the wheel? If you understand the process that got you into a mess like that, you can understand the process that gets you out. What got you in points to what gets you out.

I could tell you story after story of church staffs shocked to find out about a deacon, an associate pastor, or a pastor who, after years of service, had been carrying on an ongoing situation with the flesh.

I remember going to one church where the whole staff had entered into orgies. The church found out and got rid of the whole staff. The pastor who told me about it had himself had to leave a previous church because of an affair with a young woman. So the one who took the church had left another church because of an affair, and he replaced a staff removed because of orgies.

Most people will not admit it. It is not because they do not want to be free. It is because it hurts the people around them too much. So they are trapped in an ungodly trap.

What gets a man into a mess like that? If we find that out, we can find out what will get him out.

Ephesians 6 says:

Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might.

Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil.

How do I get strong in His might? By putting on the whole armor. That armor makes you strong in His might, not your own. He says to put on the whole armor of God so you can stand against the wiles of the devil.

"Wiles" means methodical, militaristic, well-planned schemes of the devil. The devil in the Greek has the sense of one who penetrates. So he says you need this armor because the devil stands there trying to rip pieces of armor off of you so you will be destroyed.

He will keep working on you like drops of water, year after year, month after month, decade after decade, generation after generation, until penetration is made through the rock. That describes Satan's operation against the church and against a human being.

The original picture is that Satan's body stands face to face, eye to eye, toe to toe, blow to blow with the body of Christ. He does not care if it takes twenty years. His intention is to wear you out.

Then Paul says:

For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places.

If Paul had described Satan's body the same way he described the body of Christ in 1 Corinthians 12, he might have said that Satan has placed first in his body principalities, second powers, third rulers of the darkness of this world, and fourth spiritual wickedness in high places.

When Satan runs to and fro throughout the earth seeking whom he may devour, he has principalities strategically placed around the world. I believe that in the last days there will be ten leagues of nations and a principality over each league.

Satan has charged these principalities to indoctrinate their part of the world into his way of thinking. This is why the Islamic world thinks in one way, the African world in another, the Oriental mind in another, and the Western mind in another. We are the result of being indoctrinated by principalities.

Their regions of the world think and act alike because they have been victimized and incarcerated in a prison without steel bars. It is in their thinking. That is the stronghold Paul described when he said we do not wrestle against flesh and blood.

Our weapons are mighty through God to the pulling down of fortresses that consist of imaginations, ways of thinking, and uncaptured thoughts. That kind of prison is more powerful than steel. If you were raised in an Islamic world, your chances of being saved would be almost zero, because the prison is in your mind.

How did it get there? Through a well-organized plan of indoctrination by the devil.

Satan calls his principalities together in counsel, and do not think he does not do it. Paul is describing something so organized that it is patterned after the Roman Empire. That is why he listed the armor in terms of the battle array of a Roman foot soldier.

Satan is organized. He has planned your destruction. He has planned the breakup of preachers and wives. He has planned the immorality. If you are in it, you are a victim of his plan.

But what got you in will get you out.

Satan circles the globe in counsel and says, "We have thousands chanting, fasting, and praying for the destruction of morality, and I am using them. I am using them in the media. I am placing them in strategic positions."

He uses indoctrination through media, newspapers, magazines, television, and every motel room where a person can pick any late-night thing he wants in the secrecy of his own room. David Wilkerson prophesied that years ago: the availability of pornography to clergy in the privacy of their rooms.

If you were out with me having to counsel and minister to these men, you would be shocked at how well this indoctrination has worked.

The principalities hand the mandate down to powers, and the powers hand it down to rulers of the darkness of this world. Those rulers are strategically placed around the world in multitudes. Their job is to stand guard like sentries over dark regions against invasions of light. If the gospel comes to that region, their job is to organize resistance against the onslaught of light until it is overcome through methodical breaking down and penetration.

Then the command comes down to spiritual wickedness in high places, the lower-level devils that possess people and operate on a direct level with humanity. "This is the meal for this century. The media will begin visual and sound indoctrination, the preaching of my gospel. You supply the continual hounding with emotions, lusts, harassment, and temptation until the conception of sin is made and destruction comes to the preacher, the family, and morality."

Satan circles the globe, hands down his mandate, and it comes through direct influence of devils on human beings and through indoctrination by media. That begins the undoing.

If we are going to look at the victory, we need to look at the undoing closely.

Go to 2 Corinthians 10.

For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war after the flesh:

For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds.

A stronghold is like an army fort, a fortress with walls. In a positive sense, a stronghold would be the high tower of God's thoughts, the Holy Ghost, worship, and transformation to the Word. That would be the stronghold you and I live in as far as Satan is concerned.

But Paul uses it in a negative sense. He says our weapons are not carnal, but mighty through God to pull down the fortresses Satan erects in our lives.

What kind of fortresses? Lasciviousness of the flesh, indoctrination to the flesh, out-of-control flesh, promiscuousness, pornography, and this kind of filth until Satan erects a stronghold where your life is out of control and cannot excel in God because you cannot break away from the fortress.

Then Paul tells you what these strongholds are:

Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ.

An imagination is a system of thoughts controlled or backed by emotion. Even if a man knows the way he is thinking is wrong, he cannot break away because emotion manifests itself in lust and he cannot tear away from it.

The prison is in the mind, the part of him that needs transformation.

The stronghold consists of imaginations, and those imaginations consist of high things that exalt themselves against the knowledge of God. Their intention is to unseat the throne of God's knowledge in your life and replace it with their own throne, which is against the knowledge of God.

These high things are devils, yes, but they are devils with a doctrine, a system of thoughts, and a strategic plan for your neutralization. They do not care if it takes twenty years to get you out of ministry. If they cannot get you out, they will race to enslave you so your ministry never goes anywhere, whether by flesh, money, or any other area where indoctrination into strongholds can seize a man.

Where did these high things come from? Reverse the process. They began as uncaptured thoughts, thoughts outside the captivity of Jesus Christ and His Word. Uncaptured thoughts become high things that war against the knowledge of God until they pull it down. They replace that knowledge with themselves and become systems of thought, imaginations, and a stronghold that imprisons the man.

If that system is used to indoctrinate a man, then reversing the process will get him out.

It got you born again. How shall they hear unless a preacher is sent? When you came into church, you sat down and the preacher began giving you information about God. You chose to believe it. You took your first step and were born again. Then you were transformed and renewed until the chains of the world fell off you.

It all began with one message and your indoctrination into liberty:

If ye continue in my word, then are ye my disciples indeed;
And ye shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free.

The devil knows that if he can re-indoctrinate you in reverse, you will go back, or you will never finish being set free.

Go to James 1, beginning about verse 13.

Let no man say when he is tempted, I am tempted of God: for God cannot be tempted with evil, neither tempteth he any man:
But every man is tempted, when he is drawn away of his own lust, and enticed.
Then when lust hath conceived, it bringeth forth sin: and sin, when it is finished, bringeth forth death.
Do not err, my beloved brethren.

Let no man say when he is tempted, tested, or tried, "I am tempted, tested, or tried by God." God cannot be tempted with evil, and that includes disease or anything else, much less sin. Neither does He tempt any man.

If I hear you saying a car wreck is working for your good, I will probably slap the fat out of your face. You may have come out with better character, but you could have gone to the Word and done that.

Do not err. Do not make a mistake about this.

Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, and cometh down from the Father of lights, with whom is no variableness, neither shadow of turning.

He is not part of my problem. He is part of my answer. He wanted to make sure I had no error about this. He is for my redemption, healing, prosperity, peace, joy, and holy walk before God.

Then James says:

Of his own will begat he us with the word of truth, that we should be a kind of firstfruits of his creatures.

Based on that, he says:

Wherefore, my beloved brethren, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath:

For the wrath of man worketh not the righteousness of God.

Wherefore lay apart all filthiness and superfluity of naughtiness, and receive with meekness the engrafted word, which is able to save your souls.

There it is again. Uncaptured thoughts become high things that exalt themselves against the knowledge of God, which become imaginations, which become the stronghold that puts a man in prison. Our weapons are mighty through God to pull down strongholds.

We know worship is one of those weapons. Confession, praying in the Holy Ghost, and fasting are major keys. They are not carnal weapons. But here is another kind of communication, another kind of prayer, another kind of ministry to your own soul:

Receive with meekness the engrafted word, which is able to save your souls.

Put aside all filthiness and superfluity of naughtiness, and receive the engrafted Word that is able to bring your soul out of that stockade.

James continues:

But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves.

For if any be a hearer of the word, and not a doer, he is like unto a man beholding his natural face in a glass:

For he beholdeth himself, and goeth his way, and straightway forgetteth what manner of man he was.

But whoso looketh into the perfect law of liberty, and continueth therein... this man shall be blessed in his deed.

A person who is a forgetful hearer looks into the Word, walks away, and forgets what it says because he does not subject himself to it enough.

Then James says:

If any man among you seem to be religious, and bridled not his tongue, but deceiveth his own heart, this man's religion is vain.

Pure religion and undefiled before God and the Father is this, To visit the fatherless and widows in their affliction, and to keep himself unspotted from the world.

Pure religion has two parts: meeting people's needs, and keeping yourself unspotted from the world. That is holiness, that is coming out of the stockade, and the other is the ministry of compassion.

Now let us talk about the process that gets a man out.

I was counseling a man in ministry, a Bible-school graduate, a faith person, and I almost did not know what to tell him. He looked so pathetic that if I had done what I felt like doing, I would have gotten down on my knees in a Taco Bell and cried out, "There is no hope."

But illumination came on me, and we sent him away with a plan of recovery. He was happy about it.

I asked him, "Do you want to go worship God?"

He said, "No, I do not feel like it."

"Can you make yourself do it?"

"I do not even care."

"How about confessing the Word?"

"I do not care."

"Do you feel like going to church?"

"I go to church for duty. I collect a paycheck. I have to do it or I do not eat. But I do not care."

"Have you got any life in you at all?"

"Yes. That is why I came here. Can you help me?"

I sat there praying. I could not get him to pray, confess the Word, worship, or do any of those things. I said, "God, what could I get him to do?"

All of a sudden, the Lord brought Augie David's testimony before me.

When the strong man singled Augie out for destruction, he was under such emotional beating that he was on the edge of suicide and depression. He testified about how the strong man came, probably a power, and began to break their ministry down and harass Lee. At times she would go over the edge, and Augie would have to hold her down and pray for her. She came here and got set free, and she is free now.

Augie got so frustrated that one day he threw his Bible against the wall and said, "Why do You not do what You said?" He was on the edge. At any moment he was afraid his emotions would run away with him.

The destruction of reasonings was going on. The devil was trying to reprogram him, destroy the Word in him, and destroy everything.

Augie told me something he did that sustained him. It was the only thing he could do. He did not really feel like praying. He did not feel like doing anything.

For six hours a day, when he was on the brink of destruction, Augie read the Word of God from cover to cover every two weeks for a year. He read the Old and New Testaments twenty-four times in one year. It took him an average of six hours a day.

Why did it salvage him? Because instead of the devil's thoughts pouring through Augie to his seduction, he poured the thoughts of God through himself for six hours a day. That sustained him on the brink.

So I asked the man I was counseling, "Would you read the Word of God for two hours a day? Would you take an hour in the Old Testament and an hour in the New Testament?"

He said, "I would do that. Why?"

I said, "Because it will start God's thoughts flowing through you by the thousands for two hours a day. Your uncaptured thoughts led you until emotions took over. Eventually, what you are looking for, that flicker of light, the Spirit bearing witness with yours, will begin to stir a small emotion in your soul that agrees with the Word. After a while it will be enough strength to start prayer, then enough strength to start worship, then enough strength to start confession."

I asked, "Do you think you have enough strength to take your thoughts and trade them in for two hours a day for the flow of God's thoughts, as long as needed, until your emotions begin to turn and take you out of the problem?"

You need hours and hours of His thoughts flowing through you.

Every time you crawl out from under that slimy rock after gratifying the flesh, do not say, "I read that magazine again, so I cannot read the Bible." Close the pornographic book, throw it away if you can, and start reading your Bible. It is through the Spirit that you overcome the deeds of the body.

"I thought if I was doing one, I could not do the other."

That is the biggest lie of the devil. How are you going to come out of one if you do not do the other?

Throw the book away and repent. Say, "God, thank You for forgiving me."

"But my emotions know I am lying. They know I am just going to do it again."

That is because something is compelling you inside. Even if all your emotions and thoughts lie to you, tell them to be quiet. Repent and get your Bible out.

If your emotions are not there, take your repentance by faith. Say, "Father, would You please forgive me? Thank You that You have." Then get your Bible out and start trading your thoughts for His. Read as long as you can. Make yourself read at least thirty minutes in the Old Testament and

thirty minutes in the New.

It will start God's thoughts flowing through you until your emotions begin to be replaced from the inside with His, until your want-to starts to come back and victory delivers you out of the stronghold.

That is what Augie David did.

Carol can tell you the difference. She has been reading twenty-five to forty chapters a day, with some days in prayer and some days in reading. It builds your faith. You understand the Father's nature so much more, and you begin to understand why He can do all this for you, why He will do it, and why He will do His Word.

All those thoughts begin flowing through you, and they help begin the fortification process for a person to come back out.

There is another type of prayer: communing to your own soul, praying inside with the Word, hour after hour, until your old "I do not want to" starts turning into "I want to."

You may run across a hero in there who gets you so excited that you say, "I am not going to do that anymore." It starts with that.

Let us worship God.